KK–E–561a
JUNE 9, 1948
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. KK–E–561
May 7, 1935

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ENVELOPES; LEATHER, SLIDE-FASTENER

This specification was approved by the Director, Bureau of Federal Supply for the use of all departments and establishments of the Government.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Types, sizes, classes, and styles.—Slide-fastener leather envelopes covered by this specification shall be of the following types, sizes, classes, and styles, as specified: (See fig. 1.)

Type I.—Opening on top only, without handles.

Size 14 x 10½ inches.
Size 17 x 11½ inches.

Type II.—Opening on three sides, without handles.

Size 14 x 10½ inches.
Size 17 x 11½ inches.

Type III.—Opening on three sides, with sliding handles and outside pocket.

Size 17 x 11½ inches.
Class A.—With ring binders.
Style 2.—Two inner pockets.
Style 4.—Four inner pockets.
Class B.—Without ring binders.
Style 2.—Two inner pockets.
Style 4.—Four inner pockets.

1.2 Finishes of leather.—The envelopes shall be in the following finishes of leather, as specified:

Smooth.
Boarded.
Embossed in fine grain.
Embossed in coarse grain.

1.3 Color.—Envelopes shall be brown or black, as specified.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS

2.1 Specifications.—The following Federal Specifications, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

V–T–291—Thread; Linen.
KK–L–136—Leather; Artificial (Upholstery).
KK–L–154—Leather; Bag and Case.
KK–L–311—Leather and Leather Products; General Specifications (Methods of Sampling, Inspection, and Tests).
QQ–B–611—Brass, Commercial; Bars, Plates, Rods, Shapes, Sheets, and Strips.
QQ–M–151—Metals; General Specification for Inspection of.
DDD–S–751—Stitches; Seams, and Stitching.

(Copies of Federal specifications and the Federal Specifications Index may be obtained upon application, accompanied by postal note, money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

2.2 Specifications and publications applicable only to individual departments are listed in section 7.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Leather.*—The leather shall be top-grain cowhide conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification KK–L–154, type I, grade A.

3.1.1.1 *Thickness of leather.*—The leather used in the bodies of type I and type II envelopes shall be six sixty-fourths inch thick; leather used in the bodies of type III envelopes shall be three sixty-fourths inch thick. Leather used in the gussets shall be three sixty-fourths inch thick.

3.1.1.1.1 *Thickness tolerance.*—The thickness of each piece of leather shall be subject to a plus tolerance of one-half sixty-fourth inch and a minus tolerance of one-half sixty-fourth inch over not more than 50 percent of the area.

3.1.2 *Thread.*—All stitching shall be done with not less than 4-ply lock-stitch-twist linen

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

thread conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification V–T–291, type B, or with nylon thread having equal or greater strength than the linen thread specified.

3.2 Stitching.—Stitching shall be done with six to eight stitches per inch, using stitch type 301 as described in Federal Specification DDD–S–751. At the end of each row of stitches there shall be at least three back stitches.

3.3 Design.—The envelopes shall be of the general design illustrated in figure 1 for the various types and classes.

3.4 Fasteners.—The fasteners shall be metallic interlocking slide fasteners of the non-separating open-top type, of suitable weight and strength for the purpose required. All fasteners shall be attached to a suitable tape and securely stitched to the envelope or gussets; for type I and type II envelopes, a single row of stitching shall be used; for type III envelopes, a double row of stitching at a gage of approximately ¼ inch shall be used.

3.5 Dimensions.—Dimensions of the envelopes shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I.—*Outside dimensions of envelopes, minimum*

Type and size	Width	Length	Expansion
Type I:	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*
Size 14 x 10½	14	10½	1¾
Size 17 x 11½	17	11½	1¾
Type II:			
Size 14 x 10½	14	10½	1¼
Size 17 x 11½	17	11½	1¼
Type III:			
Size 17 x 11½	17	11½	2½

3.6 Type I, opening on top only, without handles.

3.6.1 *Construction.*—Type I envelopes shall open on the top by means of a slide fastener. Each envelope shall have a front and back made from the same piece of leather, with the sides fastened by gussets. The top corners shall be cut on a radius of about 1¾ inches. The fastener shall extend down the sides for a distance of about 1½ inches from the top of the envelope.

3.6.2 *Gussets.*—Each gusset shall be of one piece of leather which matches the body leather in color and finish, and shall be secured by a flexible adhesive and a single row of stitching. The ends of the gussets shall be turned in and cemented for a distance of not less than 1 inch. In addition, the top of each gusset shall be secured to the front and the back with bifurcated rivets having the insides capped. The rivets shall be of half-hard brass conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification QQ–B–611 for composition B.

3.7 Type II, opening on three sides, without handles.

3.7.1 *Construction.*—Type II envelopes shall open on three sides by means of a slide fastener and shall lie flat when open. Each envelope shall be made of one piece of leather and shall have inner pockets. The top corners of the envelope shall be rounded. The outside edge of the envelope shall be polished and smoothly finished.

3.7.2 *Slide fastener.*—The slide fastener shall have a binding of artificial leather so stitched to the outside of the envelope that the expansion is not less than 1¼ inches. The ends of the fastener shall be sewn into a leather tab which is in turn sewn to the leather body of the envelope.

3.7.3 *Pockets.*—Each envelope shall have two full-width pockets not less than 6 inches deep. The pockets shall be made of the same leather as the body of the envelope. The pockets shall be sewn between the binding and the outside ends of the envelope, one on the front and one on the back. All edges of pockets shall be creased.

3.8 Type III, opening on three sides, with sliding handles and outside pocket.

3.8.1 *Construction.*—Type III envelopes shall open on three sides by means of a slide fastener and shall lie flat when open. Each envelope shall have a front and back made of one piece of leather and shall have two gussets to which the slide fasteners are attached. The leather of the envelope body shall be backed with rubber impregnated paper at least 0.025 inch thick. Each envelope shall have inner pockets and an outside pocket; in addition, class A shall have ring binders. The envelopes shall have double carrying handles of the sliding or disappearing type; where the handles disappear into the envelope, there shall be an interlining of artificial

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

leather approximately 4 inches by 7 inches glued to the body leather.

3.8.2 *Lining.*—The lining shall be artificial leather conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification KK–L–136 for type I. The lining shall match the color of the case as closely as possible and shall be backed with a suitable stiffening (chip) board, sewed and secured with waterproof adhesive to the envelope leather.

3.8.3 *Pockets.*—The pockets shall be of the same artificial leather as the lining, backed with suitable stiffening (chip) board and lined with rubberized cloth. The artificial leather shall be turned over the top of the cloth and cemented down with flexible adhesive for a distance of not less than ½ inch. The edges of flat pockets shall be turned under on four sides.

3.8.3.1 *Outside pocket.*—Each envelope shall have a pocket opening on the outside by means of a slide fastener. The top of the pocket shall be 1 inch from the top of the envelope; the pocket shall measure 15½ x 10 inches±⅛ inch.

3.8.3.2 *Inside pockets, style 2.*—Style 2 envelopes shall have a full-length gusseted inside pocket on one side, not less than 15½ x 7 inches, with an expansion of approximately 1¼ inches, and with a sewed-on leather pencil loop at the top. On the other side there shall be a gusseted cross pocket not less than 7 x 9 inches, with an expansion of approximately 1½ inches.

3.8.3.3 *Inside pockets, style 4.*—Style 4 envelopes shall have a full-width gusseted inside pocket on one side with an expansion of 1½ inches, on which there shall be attached two flat pockets each 6 x 7 inches±⅛ inch, and with a sewed-on leather pencil loop at the top. On the other side there shall be a gusseted cross pocket 7 x 9 inches±1 inch, with an expansion of approximately 1½ inches.

3.8.4 *Handles.*—The handles shall be made of metal without sharp edges or corners, and shall be covered with leather which matches the envelope leather; there shall be a suitable padding between the cover leather and the handle. The handles shall be inserted through the top of the envelope, between the outside leather and the lining in such a manner that they will slide or disappear within and still not be visible from the inside. There shall be a reinforcing strip of cowhide approximately 7½ inches long and 1 inch wide sewn to the lining where the handles slide between lining and cover; there shall be substantial metal strip reinforcements which shall hold the handles and prevent them from pulling loose.

3.8.5 *Gussets.*—The gussets shall match the body leather in color and finish and shall consist of two strips of leather approximately 1 inch wide reinforced with the same artificial leather as the lining; the outer edge shall be turned. The strips shall be securely sewed to the edges of the envelope on three sides, and shall be closed by the slide fastener securely sewed to each strip. All edges shall be turned and stitched and trimmed close after stitching. The slide fastener shall be sewed between the leather and the artificial leather reinforcement. The closed ends of the gusset shall be reinforced with a piece of artificial leather so that the backing is not visible from the ends when the envelope is closed.

3.8.6 *Reinforcement.*—The bottom of the envelope on the inside shall be reinforced by a strip of the same leather as the envelope body. This reinforcing strip shall be approximately 2½ inches wide and shall extend the full width of the case. The reinforcing strips shall be sewed in such a manner that neither the raw edges of the leather nor the stitching is exposed.

3.8.7 *Ring binders, class A.*—Class A envelopes shall have binders with 3-ring mechanism and metal ring protectors approximately 11½ inches long securely fastened throughout the width of the case.

3.8.7.1 *Spacing.*—The distance between rings shall be the standard commercial spacing for the type of opening and the size of the sheet (11 x 8½ inches).

3.8.7.2 *Rings.*—The rings shall be made of nickel-plated steel wire not less than $^{3}/_{32}$ inch in diameter, and shall be securely fastened to the prong plates. The rings shall have a Rockwell hardness of not less than 65 on the B scale. The rings shall fit snugly when closed.

3.8.7.3 *Prong plates.*—Each rib or plate shall measure not less than 0.045 inch by $^{11}/_{16}$ inch over-all in cross section. Each rib or plate shall be of the strip type, made of cold-rolled steel having a Rockwell hardness of not less than 80 on the B scale.

3.8.7.4 *Booster triggers.*—Booster triggers shall be made of nickel-plated steel not less than

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

0.055 inch thick, and shall be sufficiently rugged.

3.8.7.5 *Spring or tension plate.*—The spring shall be made from nickel-plated cold-rolled steel not less than 0.015 inch thick, having a Rockwell hardness of not less than 65 on the B scale.

3.9 Workmanship.—The envelopes shall be free from defects which affect their appearance or which may affect their serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Unless otherwise specified, one envelope of each type, size, class, and style shall be taken at random from each lot of 100 or fraction thereof delivered, for test.

4.2 Inspection.—All envelopes delivered shall be visually inspected for obvious items of construction and surface defects of the leather to determine compliance with this specification.

4.2.1 *Dimensions.*—The length and width dimensions shall be determined by measurements made on the outside of the envelope. The expansion shall be measured on the outside of the envelope between the edges of the gusset.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Leather.*—Tests on the leather shall be made in accordance with the applicable methods described in Federal Specification KK–L–311.

4.3.2 *Metal.*—Tests for Rockwell hardness shall be made in accordance with methods described in Federal Specification QQ–M–151.

4.3.3 *Artificial leather.*—Tests on artificial leather shall be made in accordance with methods described in Federal Specification KK–L–136.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.—Unless otherwise specified, commercial packages are acceptable under this specification.

5.2 Packing.—The subject commodity shall be prepared for shipment to permit acceptance by carrier for transportation at the lowest applicable rate, and to afford maximum protection from normal hazards of transportation.

5.3 Marking.—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the item, the type, class, style, size, and the quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering information.—Purchasers should specify the type, size, finish, and color, and in addition, for type III, the class and style, and should exercise any desired options offered herein. (See 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 4.1, 5.1, and 5.3.)

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

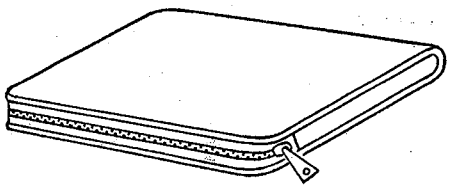
7.1 The following departmental inspection, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, forms a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective department:

7.2 Army.—U. S. Army Specification 100–2, Standard Specification for Marking Shipments by Contractors.

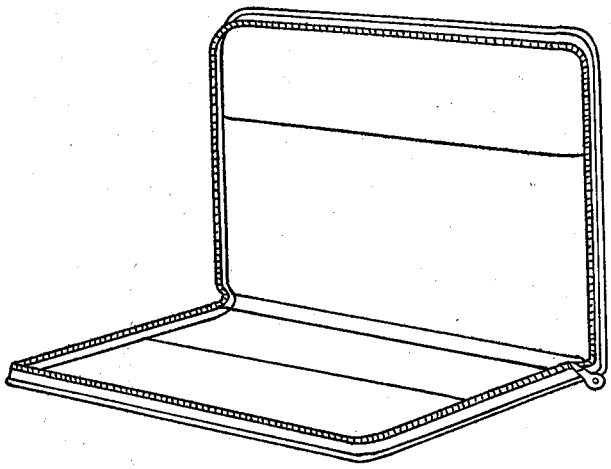
(Copies of specifications required for Army purchases may be obtained upon application to the procuring agency. Both the title and identifying symbol or number should be stipulated when requesting copies.)

This specification is a part of Section IV, Part 5, of the Federal Standard Stock Catalog

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



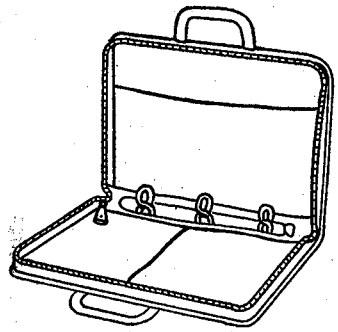
Type I. Opening on top only, without handles



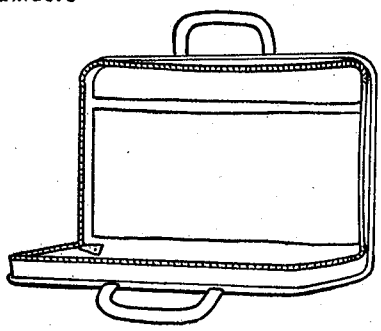
Type II. Opening on three sides, without handles



Type III. Opening on three sides, with sliding handles



Class A. With ring binders



Class B. Without ring binders

FIGURE 1.—Slide-fastener leather envelopes

For sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.
Price [illegible] its

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.